some new, exciting, and admittedly tentative proposals that draw provocative connections between quantum entanglement and how spacetime bends and curves—the phenomenon you and I know as “gravity.” For many years now, the search for a complete and compelling quantum theory of gravity has been recognized as an important scientific goal (prestige, prizes, stealing away faculty, and all that). It may be that the secret is not to start with gravity and “quantize” it, but to dig deeply into quantum mechanics itself, and find that gravity was lurking there all along.

We don’t know for sure. That’s the excitement and anxiety of cutting-edge research. But the time has come to take the fundamental nature of reality seriously, and that means confronting quantum mechanics head-on.